

Sol-fa

Musical Games





About the Course

Students play musical games to notice rhythm and melody.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Music: Intro



Placement & Combining Tips

Suitable for Grades 1-3 if combining



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1	Sol-fa: Musical Games 1 time/week 10 min	Musical Games Playlist

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Music: Intro				
Sol-fa: Musical Games	Hymns & Spirituals Afternoon Listening		Folk Songs	Music Appreciation



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Sol-fa: Musical Games

☐ Bookmark the Musical Games Playlist (in Quick Links), which includes many selections from the term.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Sol-fa: Musical Games



Our Work: Grades 1-2



Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF



Musical Games Playlist



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Sol-fa: Musical Games

∞ [Musical Games Playlist](#)

∞ [Appendix: Waltz Steps](#)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



Sol-fa: Musical Games

How To Teach



Recap

- Connect each lesson to the previous one for that topic.
- For music appreciation study, a recap might look like a brief discussion about the name or sound of the piece or instrument you listened to previously.
- For hymns and folk songs, this might be an effort to hum the melody or recite the words of the song you're currently learning.



Introduce

Prepare to listen to the day's musical selection or activity by inviting students to consider an interesting musical or historical idea in the lesson, perhaps a unique word, rhythm, instrument, or piece of historical background (usually included in lesson plans).



Listen & Practice

- Listen to the day's musical selection or practice the activity.
- Music Appreciation lessons will usually have you listen to a piece of music for 3-8 minutes. If students have a difficult time listening for the duration of the lesson, stop the music at their limit.
- Movement is always a great way to encourage students to engage with the music. Sometimes the lessons will provide a suggestion, but students may make up their own using their whole bodies or creating finger plays. They may also draw, color, or act out a dance with stuffed animals, dolls, or other figures.
- Hymn, folk song, or musical games will sometimes have you listen to a part of the song and then practice echoing back the melody and/or words.



Discuss

Let students share any thoughts or connections they have about the lesson.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 1

Moving and Music

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

"Here We Go Round the Mulberry Bush." Follow the movement directions, ensuring that larger groups or students with spatial perception differences have enough room.
∞ Video Link: [Here We Go Round the Mulberry Bush](#)

→ SING

Now try singing the song and make up some new actions (possibilities: "this is the way we clap our hands," "sweep the floor," or "dance around").

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Along with the lesson's songs, read stories and/or listen to songs about Winnie the Pooh.

∞ Audio Link: [Afternoons: Pooh Songs](#)

WEEK 2 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 2

Join-in Rhymes

PREP: Print out and read over instructions.

∞ Link: ["The Owl" and "Here We Go"](#)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Read "The Owl" and "Here We Go" aloud and tell the students what they are going to say with you (the italicized parts). You may want to read the poem aloud first and then have the students join in the second time. Tell the students to copy you closely. Exaggerate louds, softs, ascending, descending tones of your voice.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Along with the lesson's songs, read stories and/or listen to songs about Winnie the Pooh.

∞ Audio Link: [Afternoons: Pooh Songs](#)

WEEK 3 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 3

Acting

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Today's songs need your help. In the first one, you need to pretend to be a teapot, and for the second one, you're going to make a lot of animal noises.

∞ Audio Link: [I'm a Little Teapot](#)

∞ Audio Link: [Old MacDonald Had a Farm](#)

→ SING

With any extra lesson time, make up some new verses about other animals to "Old MacDonald Had a Farm."

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Along with the lesson's songs, read stories and/or listen to songs about Winnie the Pooh.

∞ Audio Link: [Afternoons: Pooh Songs](#)

WEEK 4 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 4

Improvising

→ RECAP

Sing as much of "I'm a Little Teapot" or "Old MacDonald Had a Farm" as you can without the music.

→ SING

Sing along with the songs today. Make up verses or add any you made up last time.

∞ Audio Link: [I'm a Little Teapot](#)

∞ Audio Link: [Old MacDonald Had a Farm](#)

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Along with the lesson's songs, read stories and/or listen to songs about Winnie the Pooh.

∞ Audio Link: [Afternoons: Pooh Songs](#)

WEEK 5 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 5

Dwarfs and Giants

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Listen to "In the Hall..." by Edvard Grieg. Tiptoe with hands on hips when the music is soft. When it is loud, pretend to be a giant and march with your hands high in the air. During the second song, stand in one place, but move your body up and down as the music gets louder or softer. You can also swing your arms and twist with the music.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Along with the lesson's songs, read stories and/or listen to songs about Winnie the Pooh.

∞ Audio Link: [Afternoons: Pooh Songs](#)

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Term 1

	Ensure that larger groups or students with spatial perception differences have enough room. ∞ Audio Link: In the Hall of the Mountain King ∞ Audio Link: Morning Mood	
WEEK 6	10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 6 <i>Skipping</i> → LISTEN & PRACTICE Today we're going to have fun skipping! (Teacher should demonstrate how to skip to make sure students know how; if skipping is too challenging, teachers can model a shuffle instead.) Listen to "Skip to My Lou" and practice skipping with the music. ∞ Audio Link: Skip to My Lou	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Along with the lesson's songs, read stories and/or listen to songs about Winnie the Pooh. ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Pooh Songs
WEEK 7	10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 7 <i>Skipping Part 2</i> → RECAP Skip in a circle. If skipping is too challenging, students may shuffle instead. → PRACTICE We're going to skip more today, but this time, see if you can skip sideways! Try sideways skipping (left and right). (If there is a group of students, have them take hands and skip sideways in a ring.) Try to make up another way to skip (maybe backwards!). After you feel confident, skip and sing with the music. ∞ Audio Link: Skip to My Lou	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Along with the lesson's songs, read stories and/or listen to songs about Winnie the Pooh. ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Pooh Songs
WEEK 8	10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 8 <i>Guessing Instruments</i> PREP: Think of how you want to imitate different instruments for your student to guess. → PRACTICE Imitate various instruments and have your students guess what they are. If students find this excessively difficult, do it together or make it a funny game of charades.	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Along with the lesson's songs, read stories and/or listen to songs about Winnie the Pooh. ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Pooh Songs
WEEK 9	10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 9 <i>Echoing</i> → SING You get to echo the singer in this song. (Sing with the kids in the audio.) Sing the song through a few times. ∞ Audio Link: My Aunt Came Back → DISCUSS Where are some of the places the aunt went? Look them up on your map. (Click on countries or islands to zoom in to find the cities/places mentioned in the song.) ∞ Map Link: Clickable World Map	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Along with the lesson's songs, read stories and/or listen to songs about Winnie the Pooh. ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Pooh Songs
WEEK 10	10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 10 <i>"My Aunt Came Back" (cont.)</i> → RECAP Keep practicing "My Aunt Came Back." Can you hum the tune without the music?	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Along with the lesson's songs, read stories and/or listen to songs about Winnie the Pooh. ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Pooh Songs

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Term 1		
	→ SING Sing the song through a few times with the audio, then try singing it on your own. ∞ Audio Link: My Aunt Came Back	
WEEK 11	10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 11 <i>Walking to a Beat</i> → PRACTICE Can you walk at a very steady speed? Try to take steps so that your foot hits the ground with every tap of the stick in this song--you may want to play it more than once. If you can't walk with the taps perfectly, don't worry. Some things take practice. After you're done walking, listen to the song again and see if you can learn the words. ∞ Audio Link: Hickory Dickory Dock (Note: This song is on Spotify. You will need a free account to listen to it.)	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Along with the lesson's songs, read stories and/or listen to songs about Winnie the Pooh. ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Pooh Songs
WEEK 12	10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 12 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Musical Games Coursework → NOTE Exams are optional for this course as the focus is on enjoyment and fun.	

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Term 2

WEEK 1 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 13

Meowing

→ INTRO

Listen to these two cats. I bet they can “meow” better than any other cats you’ve ever heard.

∞ Audio Link: Duet for Two Cats

→ PRACTICE

Now you meow too!

∞ Audio Link: Meow Game

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Songs from the lesson and “Wee Sing Songs.”

∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Children’s Songs & Fingerplays

∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Around the World

WEEK 2 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 14

Nutcracker and Imitating

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Start watching the Nutcracker Ballet, and try to imitate the dancers’ moves.

∞ Video Link: Nutcracker Ballet

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Songs from the lesson and “Wee Sing Songs.”

∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Children’s Songs & Fingerplays

∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Around the World

WEEK 3 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 15

Nutcracker Ballet (cont.)

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Keep watching the Nutcracker Ballet and try to imitate the dancers’ moves.

∞ Video Link: Nutcracker Ballet

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Songs from the lesson and “Wee Sing Songs.”

∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Children’s Songs & Fingerplays

∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Around the World

WEEK 4 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 16

Guessing Melodies

PREP: Select several songs/melodies with which your child is familiar. (Pick some that the student will know quickly and some that are harder to recognize.)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Play each melody and ask the student to guess the melody. Intersperse lesser-known pieces with the more familiar ones until lesson time is over.

∞ Audio Link: Musical Games Playlist

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Songs from the lesson and “Wee Sing Songs.”

∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Children’s Songs & Fingerplays

∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Around the World

WEEK 5 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 17

Fingerplay

→PREP & PRACTICE

Learn this fingerplay song, and then teach it to your students during the lesson.

∞ Video Link: Open, Shut Them

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Songs from the lesson and “Wee Sing Songs.”

∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Children’s Songs & Fingerplays

∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Around the World

WEEK 6 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 18

Clapping and Marching in Time

📄 Materials: Item to balance on head while marching

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Balance item on your head while doing the following:

- Clap with the music.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Songs from the lesson and “Wee Sing Songs.”

∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Children’s Songs & Fingerplays

∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Around the World

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Term 2

	• Walk with the music. • March with the music (lifting knees). • Turn with directions (if the student knows directions, the teacher may call out “about right,” “about left,” etc.) ∞ Audio Link: Farewell to a Slavic Woman ∞ Audio Link: Pomp and Circumstance	
WEEK 7	10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 19 <i>Singing and Imitating</i> → SING Today we're going to start learning a song called “Over in the Meadow.” Imitate each of the animals that the singer describes. Listen to the song again and sing along where you can. ∞ Audio Link: Over in the Meadow → DISCUSS Do you think there should be more animals in the meadow? What would they be?	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Songs from the lesson and “Wee Sing Songs.” ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Children's Songs & Fingerplays ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Around the World
WEEK 8	10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 20 <i>“Over in the Meadow” (cont.)</i> → RECAP Hum/sing as much of “Over in the Meadow” as you can. → LISTEN & PRACTICE Listen to and practice the song and imitate the animals; try to remember them all and sing by yourself. ∞ Audio Link: Over in the Meadow	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Songs from the lesson and “Wee Sing Songs.” ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Children's Songs & Fingerplays ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Around the World
WEEK 9	10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 21 <i>“Hokey Pokey” Dance</i> → RECAP Review right and left hands, elbows, etc., with students. → NOTE Make a circle (large enough for all students to have plenty of room; an arm's length is a good rule). → DANCE Follow the directions in the song and put arms, legs, etc., in and out of the circle. When the song says “do the hokey pokey,” students turn around in a circle and clap their hands. Dance with students to demonstrate. ∞ Audio Link: Hokey Pokey	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Songs from the lesson and “Wee Sing Songs.” ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Children's Songs & Fingerplays ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Around the World
WEEK 10	10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 22 <i>“Hokey Pokey” Dance (cont.)</i> → RECAP Do you remember the “Hokey Pokey”? Take a few minutes to do the dance. → NOTE Make a circle (large enough for all students). ∞ Audio Link: Hokey Pokey	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Songs from the lesson and “Wee Sing Songs.” ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Children's Songs & Fingerplays ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Around the World

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Term 2		
	→ SING Start learning a new song. First listen, then echo the singer. ∞ Audio Link: Bill Grogan's Goat	
WEEK 11	10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 23 Sing-Along Song → SING Hum "Bill Grogan's Goat." Then listen and sing along. ∞ Audio Link: Bill Grogan's Goat	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Songs from the lesson and "Wee Sing Songs." ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Children's Songs & Fingerplays ∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Wee Sing Around the World
WEEK 12	10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Musical Games Coursework → NOTE Exams are optional for this course as the focus is on enjoyment and fun.	

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Term 3

WEEK 1 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 25

Marching Part 2

Materials: Item to balance on head while marching

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

As you listen to these marches, lift your knees high like a soldier marching, shoulders back, chest out.

∞ Audio Link: Washington Post March

→ VIEW

View soldiers marching. Try swinging your arms while marching and balancing something on your head. If the item keeps falling, students might use a hand to help or try a small, soft item.

∞ Video Link: Soldiers Marching

• AFTERNOON LISTENING
Songs from the lesson and the "Hole in the Bucket" and "Had a Little Rooster" playlists.
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Had a Little Rooster
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: There's a Hole in the Bucket

WEEK 2 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 26

Animal Guessing Game

→ PRACTICE

Imitate different animals and have the students guess which animal you are imitating. Then allow students to act out their own versions of animals for you to guess. Suggestions: strut like a turkey, hop like a rabbit, etc.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING
Songs from the lesson and the "Hole in the Bucket" and "Had a Little Rooster" playlists.
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Had a Little Rooster
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: There's a Hole in the Bucket

WEEK 3 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 27

An Echoing Song

→ SING

After the singer sings a line, sing it with the children in the recording. Listen several times to catch the words and melody.

∞ Audio Link: Purple Light

(Note: This song is on Spotify. You will need a free account to listen to it.)

• AFTERNOON LISTENING
Songs from the lesson and the "Hole in the Bucket" and "Had a Little Rooster" playlists.
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Had a Little Rooster
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: There's a Hole in the Bucket

WEEK 4 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 28

Tongue Twisters

PREP: Select a few tongue twisters to teach your students.

∞ Link: Tongue Twisters

→ DISCUSS

Explain what a tongue twister is, and then teach your students a few short ones. Speak slowly and clearly. Some students may benefit from repeating line by line; others may benefit from accentuating the rhythm with a 'sing-song' voice.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING
Songs from the lesson and the "Hole in the Bucket" and "Had a Little Rooster" playlists.
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Had a Little Rooster
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: There's a Hole in the Bucket

WEEK 5 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 29

Moving to ¾ Time

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Listen to some of this collection of tunes. Every time the song changes, use a different movement.

∞ Audio Link: Waltz Music

→ NOTE

Teachers should initially direct movements, then let students choose their own after a

• AFTERNOON LISTENING
Songs from the lesson and the "Hole in the Bucket" and "Had a Little Rooster" playlists.
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Had a Little Rooster
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: There's a Hole in the Bucket

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Term 3

few tunes. Suggestions: swing arms back and forth, twirl around, pretend to be a conductor, march, tiptoe, etc. Encourage students to listen closely to music and try to make their movements “match” it.

WEEK 6 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 30

Fingerplay

→ PRACTICE

We're going to learn a fingerplay called “The Eensy Weensy Spider” today. You may have heard the song before, but did you know that you can use your fingers to act it out?

∞ Video Link: Eensy Weensy Spider Fingerplay

• AFTERNOON LISTENING
Songs from the lesson and the “Hole in the Bucket” and “Had a Little Rooster”
playlists.
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Had a Little Rooster
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: There's a Hole in the Bucket

WEEK 7 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 31

Spelling and Clapping

→ SING

We're going to start learning a spelling-and-clapping song today. With each verse, the singer is going to drop a letter of BINGO, the dog's name in the song. You need to clap or stomp your feet instead of singing the letter. By the end of the song, you'll be doing a lot of stomping and clapping. Listen to the song first, so you get an idea of how it goes.

∞ Video Link: BINGO with Lyrics

• AFTERNOON LISTENING
Songs from the lesson and the “Hole in the Bucket” and “Had a Little Rooster”
playlists.
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Had a Little Rooster
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: There's a Hole in the Bucket

WEEK 8 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 32

“BINGO” (cont.)

→ RECAP

Can you sing BINGO from memory?

→ SING

See if you can sing the song with the video and correctly stomp or clap every dropped letter.

∞ Video Link: BINGO with Lyrics

• AFTERNOON LISTENING
Songs from the lesson and the “Hole in the Bucket” and “Had a Little Rooster”
playlists.
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Had a Little Rooster
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: There's a Hole in the Bucket

WEEK 9 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 33

Basic Waltz Step

PREP: Use Waltz Step Instructions (see Appendix) to learn and teach the waltz step.

→ NOTE

If you do this as a group activity in couples, couples should step sideways rather than forward. (The couple should move together, which means one of them will be moving with the opposite foot.)

→ PRACTICE

Today, we're going to learn a waltz step.

∞ Audio Link: Moon River with Orchestra

• AFTERNOON LISTENING
Songs from the lesson and the “Hole in the Bucket” and “Had a Little Rooster”
playlists.
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: Had a Little Rooster
∞ Audio Link: Afternoons: There's a Hole in the Bucket

WEEK 10 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 34

Waltz Step (cont.)

→ NOTE

Remember that the goal in learning this waltz step is for the student to continue developing his/her attention to rhythm, awareness of space, melody, appreciation of the music, etc., rather than learning to perform it perfectly.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING
Dance the waltz step with a group of people using the recordings from the lesson.

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Term 3		
	→ RECAP Dance the waltz step from the last lesson without music and with only counting, then practice it with the music. ∞ Audio Link: Moon River with Orchestra ∞ Audio Link: Ashokan's Farewell	
WEEK 11	📅 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 35 <i>Year Recap/Catch Up</i> → RECAP Ask students to name one or two of their favorite songs/dances/activities from the year. Or use this time to make up any missed lessons. → PRACTICE Practice a favorite song or dance.	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Favorite audios from the term and/or year.
WEEK 12	📅 10m Sol-fa: Musical Games - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Musical Games Coursework → NOTE Exams are optional for this course as the focus is on enjoyment and fun.	

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Examination

Term 1 · Sing a favorite song, do a favorite activity/dance, or draw/paint a favorite piece.

Term 2 · Sing a favorite song, do a favorite activity/dance, or draw/paint a favorite piece.

Term 3 · Sing a favorite song, do a favorite activity/dance, or draw/paint a favorite piece.